



Budget Wireless Headphone

Cost-effective cordless cans

This year, we received a lot of budget wireless headphones for the Digit Zero1 Awards under the compelling price bracket of ₹10,000. Nevertheless, don't mistake these inexpensive cans for inadequate ones since the budget wireless headphone category is also seeing massive improvements, be it in specifications, features or performance. Users can now experience advanced technologies such as Active Noise Cancellation, app support, voice assistant integration and others by spending half or less of what they'd have to shelve out before to get access to these features. The one deserving of this award would be one that manages to provide a balanced sound signature in a sea of bass-biased headphones, which is usually the norm in this price range. Read on to find out which budget wireless headphone snagged the 2021 Zero1 Award for the best performing wireless headphone.

Winner: Soundcore Life Q30

The Soundcore Life Q30 impressed us with its mid-range frequency response allowing for detailed and crisp-sounding vocals and lead instruments. It also has a pretty good bass response that has some punch to it but doesn't overpower the detail in the mid-range. The high-end frequency response is pretty decent as well, however, the roll-off is a bit abrupt at times. The imaging is fantastic, however, the soundstage could be wider. The Soundcore Life Q30 also shines when it comes to battery life, providing users with well over 30 hours of listening time. Overall, the Soundcore Life Q30 is an excellent budget wireless headphone with a pleasing sound signature and impressive battery life, which makes it deserving of the Digit Zero1 Award.

Runner Up: PlayGo BH47

The PlayGo BH47 is a great entry-level on-ear wireless headphone for those who want to experience some ANC goodness without breaking the bank. However, the Active Noise



Soundcore Life Q30

Price: ₹7,999



Cancellation performance on these headphones is strictly mediocre. The headphones offer a fairly balanced sound profile with dynamic bass response and detailed mids. At this range, we're used to the sound signature being too bass-biased, so it was refreshing to see that PlayGo hasn't gone down that route. You get a pretty balanced sound signature with a slight boost in bass response that gives it some energy and thump but doesn't turn things muddy. The mid-range is clear and detailed for the most part, however, the highs can sound slightly imprecise at times. The microphone performance leaves something to be desired though. Battery life, however, is pretty stellar, providing most users with a few days worth of usage.



PlayGo BH47

Price: ₹6,999

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boAt Rockerz 550

Price: ₹1,999

Best Buy: boAt Rockerz 550

Priced at ₹1,999, the boAt Rockerz 550 is a value-for-money Bluetooth headphone with 50 mm dynamic drivers that produce a bass-rich sound signature that boAt is known for. Despite the bass bias, boAt has done a decent job at ensuring that the mids and highs are still prominent in the mix. However, the passive isolation is less than adequate on these headphones and you may feel the need to turn up the volume levels to properly immerse yourself in the sound. The battery life is pretty decent for the price. In our tests, we recorded 17 hours of wireless playtime at 50 per cent volume. A decent sound signature and good battery life contribute to the boAt Rockerz 550 winning our Best Buy recommendation in this category.

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